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- Inspect the entire screen surface for sharpness and re-focus peripheral zones as needed.

Calibration and picture settings

Accurate picture calibration optimizes contrast, color, and brightness for your environment.

1. Select the right picture mode:

Choose “Cinema,” “Filmmaker,” or “ISF Dark Room” presets for dark-room viewing; “Game” or “Bright” modes for ambient-light situations.

2. Adjust brightness and contrast:

- Use a calibration disc or built-in grayscale patterns to set black level (brightness) so shadow detail is visible but blacks remain deep.
- Increase contrast until white clipping begins, then back off slightly to preserve highlight detail.

3. Color Temperature and Gamma:

- Set color temperature to “Warm” (6500 K) for accurate whites; avoid “Cool” modes that shift toward blue.
- Select gamma 2.2 for mixed lighting or 2.4 for dedicated dark-room viewing.

4. Color and tint:

- Use color bars to adjust the color (saturation) control so each bar blends naturally into gray without colored fringes.
- Adjust tint (hue) so skin tones appear neutral – neither green nor magenta.

5. Sharpness and noise reduction:

- Set sharpness to minimum or zero to avoid artificial edge enhancement.
- Disable noise reduction unless watching highly compressed content, as it can introduce lag or smear.

6. Professional calibration:

For ultimate accuracy, engage an ISF or THX-certified calibrator using a spectroradiometer and calibration software (e.g., CalMAN, LightSpace) to generate custom 3D LUTs.

Maintenance and care

Routine upkeep extends projector life and preserves image quality.

■ Lens cleaning:

Gently wipe the lens with a microfiber cloth and approved optical cleaner; never use compressed air, which can force debris into the optics.

■ Air filter and vents:

Clean or replace air filters every 500–1,000 hours per manu-

CHECKLIST: DON'T FORGET

- Select projector technology (lamp, LED, laser) suited to longevity and brightness needs.
- Calculate throw ratio and distance using online tools or manual math.
- Match lumen output to room ambient light and screen size (ANSI vs. LED lumens).
- Choose appropriate screen material: matte, high-gain, grey, or ALR (including UST-specific).
- Mount projector securely: ceiling or shelf, with precise distance and alignment.
- Perform lens shift, keystone, and corner correction for a perfectly squared image.
- Calibrate picture: brightness, contrast, color temperature, gamma, and disable unnecessary processing.
- Conduct regular maintenance: lens, filters, lamp replacement, and firmware updates.
- Maintain environmental conditions: temperature, humidity, and dust control.
- Review real-world examples to adapt settings and hardware to your unique space.

facturer guidance to maintain airflow and prevent overheating. Inspect vents monthly and remove dust with a soft brush or vacuum on low suction.

■ Power cycling:

Always power down using the projector’s shutdown sequence; wait for the cooling fan to stop before unplugging to protect the lamp and electronics.

■ Lamp replacement:

Monitor lamp hours via the on-screen menu; replace lamps when brightness falls below acceptable levels (typically 50–60% of original).

■ Firmware updates:

Periodically check the manufacturer’s website or companion app for firmware updates that improve performance and fix bugs.

■ Environmental control:

Maintain ambient temperature between 10–35 °C and humidity below 85%; avoid dusty or smoky rooms that accelerate optical degradation.

By following these detailed, step-by-step instructions, you can harness the full potential of projection technology to create a truly immersive home cinema experience. **1**